

RETAIL ANALYTICS

Executive Decision Report & Capstone Presentation

Evidence-led decisions from the supplied January 2026 retail transaction dataset

■13,557.65 Net sales	10 Orders	■1,355.77 Average order value	13.0% Average discount
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Prepared for mentor / C-suite review • Final portfolio artifact

1. Executive summary

What management should know from the supplied dataset

■ **13.56K**
Net sales

51.97%
Course Access share

■ **4,825.45**
Professional revenue

48.28%
Non-paid status share

Decision signal

- Course Access generated the largest category revenue: ■7,045.30 (52.0% of net sales).
- Professional customers generated the highest segment revenue in this dataset: ■4,825.45.
- Only 51.7% of net sales were associated with Paid transactions; Pending, Refunded and Failed statuses together represented 48.3%.
- Discounting is a material control issue: ■2,727.35 of discounts were recorded, including one 100% discount transaction.

Management response

- Protect and expand the leading Course Access offer while monitoring concentration.
- Build a targeted Professional-segment growth plan, but validate with a larger sample before scaling.
- Introduce payment and discount controls as monthly management KPIs.
- Treat ROI figures as scenario estimates, not historical results.

2. Scope & methodology

Transparent analysis boundaries increase decision confidence

10 Transactions analysed	Jan 2026 Time period	3 Categories	3 Customer segments
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Analytical workflow

- Reviewed transaction-level fields: date, segment, city, category, quantity, price, discount and payment status.
- Calculated gross sales, discount amount and net sales.
- Aggregated revenue by category, segment, city and payment status.
- Converted findings into management actions, scenario ROI and implementation milestones.

Data limitations

- The supplied file contains 10 transactions from one month only.
- There is no historical series sufficient to establish a true revenue trend or volatility pattern.
- Some location data is marked Unknown.
- Therefore, conclusions describe the supplied dataset and should not be generalized without validation.

Formula: Net sales = Gross sales – Discount amount. Average order value = Net sales ÷ Orders.

3. KPI snapshot

The financial baseline for the decision

■16,285.00 Gross sales	■2,727.35 Discount value	■13,557.65 Net sales	15 Units sold	■1,355.77 AOV
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Commercial baseline

The dataset records ■16,285.00 gross sales and ■13,557.65 net sales after ■2,727.35 of discounts.

Discount rate

Total discount value equals 16.7% of gross sales. The transaction-level average discount field is 13.0%, because the average is calculated per transaction rather than weighted by sales.

Interpretation

Discounting should be governed by clear approval thresholds, especially where discounts can eliminate net revenue.

Order economics

10 orders generated an average order value of ■1,355.77 and 15 total units.

Management KPI set

Track net sales, AOV, discount value %, paid revenue %, pending revenue %, refund %, and failed-payment value each month.

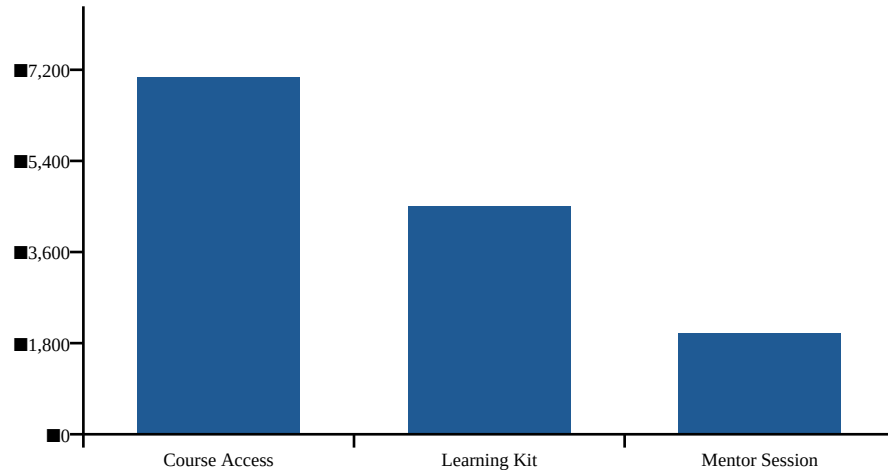
Decision confidence

Use these KPIs as a baseline; add more months before making structural budget commitments.

4. Key revenue drivers

Category mix identifies where revenue protection and growth should focus

Net sales by category



Category revenue mix



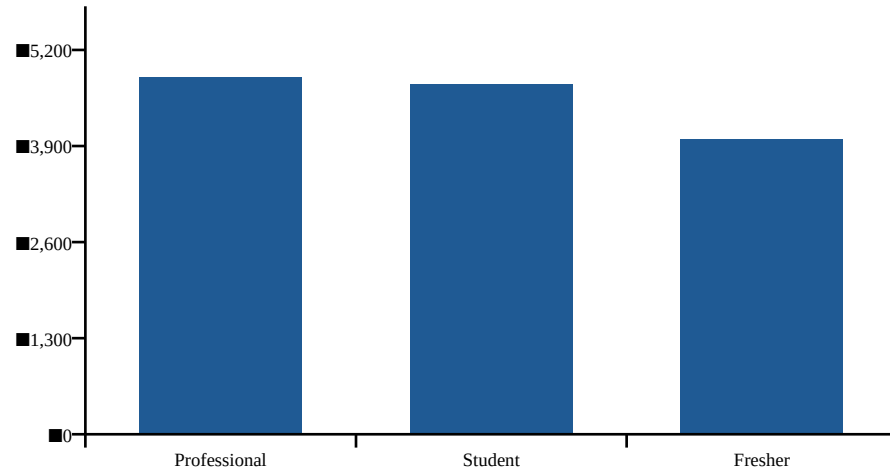
Course Access leads with ■7,045.30, representing 51.97% of net sales. Learning Kit contributes ■4,514.35; Mentor Session contributes ■1,998.00.

Executive implication: the leading category deserves protection and controlled expansion, while concentration should be monitored so growth does not depend on one offer.

5. Customer segment findings

Professional customers generated the highest revenue in the supplied dataset

Net sales by customer segment



Professional

■ 4,825.45 net sales across 3 orders; highest segment revenue in this dataset.

Student

■ 4,735.20 net sales across 4 orders; close to Professional revenue and the largest order count.

Fresher

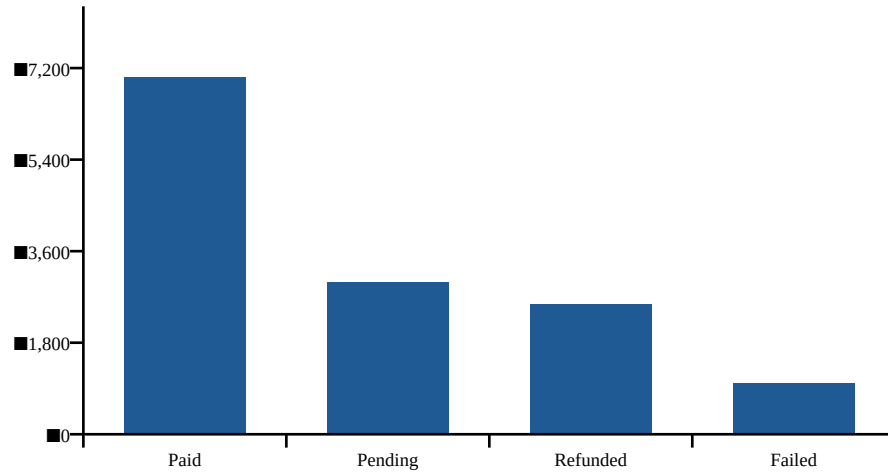
■ 3,997.00 net sales across 3 orders.

Decision caution: the gap between Professional and Student revenue is only ■90.25, so segment leadership should not be treated as a durable market ranking without additional periods.

6. Payment & revenue risk

Nearly half of net sales are not currently associated with Paid status

Net sales by payment status



Status mix

- Paid: ■7,012.35 (51.72%).
- Pending: ■2,998.00 (22.11%).
- Refunded: ■2,548.30 (18.80%).
- Failed: ■999.00 (7.37%).

Control priority: reduce unresolved payment exposure and monitor refund/failed-payment value as operational KPIs.

7. Risk areas & controls

Concentration, discounting and payment status are the clearest management controls

Risk area	Observed evidence	Management control
Category concentration	Course Access = 51.97% of net sales	Track category share monthly; set concentration alert threshold
Geographic concentration	Chennai = 27.56% of net sales	Validate city mix with more periods before geographic expansion
Discount exposure	■2,727.35 total discounts; one 100% discount	Require approval for extreme discounts and audit exceptions
Payment performance	51.72% of net sales associated with Paid status	Track pending/refund/failed value and aging
Data quality	1 transaction has Unknown city	Make city capture mandatory

Important: the source risk file reports monthly revenue variability as 0%, but this is not evidence of stable revenue because only one month is present.

8. Strategic recommendation 1

Protect and selectively expand Course Access

Evidence

Course Access generated █7,045.30, or 51.97% of net sales — the largest category contribution in the supplied dataset.

Action plan

- Create a focused Course Access campaign and cross-sell path.
- Protect price realization by limiting broad discounting.
- Monitor category share, net sales and AOV monthly.

Success measures

- Net sales growth vs. baseline.
- Category share remains healthy without excessive discounting.
- AOV and paid conversion improve.

Scenario ROI: █100K illustrative investment → █150K illustrative benefit → █50K net benefit → 50% ROI. This is a planning scenario, not a measured forecast.

9. Strategic recommendation 2

Develop a targeted Professional-segment growth plan

Evidence

Professional customers generated ■4,825.45 across 3 orders, narrowly ahead of Students at ■4,735.20.

Action plan

- Test targeted bundles and offers for Professional customers.
- Use segment-level AOV and repeat-purchase tracking.
- Compare Professional vs. Student response before scaling spend.

Success measures

- Professional segment net sales.
- Repeat purchase / conversion rate when available.
- AOV and discount rate by segment.

Scenario ROI: ■150K illustrative investment → ■225K illustrative benefit → ■75K net benefit → 50% ROI. Validate assumptions through a pilot.

10. Strategic recommendation 3

Strengthen payment, discount and concentration controls

Evidence

Only 51.72% of net sales are associated with Paid status; discounts total ■2,727.35; one transaction carries a 100% discount.

Action plan

- Add a monthly payment-status dashboard and aging review.
- Create approval rules for extreme discounts.
- Monitor category and city revenue concentration.

Success measures

- Paid revenue share.
- Pending/refunded/failed value as a percentage of net sales.
- Discount value as a percentage of gross sales.

Scenario ROI: ■120K illustrative investment → ■180K illustrative benefit → ■60K net benefit → 50% ROI. Benefit should be validated from avoided leakage and recovered revenue.

11. ROI scenario & implementation roadmap

A staged plan reduces execution risk and creates measurable checkpoints

Recommendation	Investment	Scenario benefit	Net benefit	ROI
Course Access expansion	■100K	■150K	■50K	50%
Professional segment strategy	■150K	■225K	■75K	50%
Risk monitoring & optimization	■120K	■180K	■60K	50%
Total	■370K	■555K	■185K	50%

0–30 days	31–90 days	3–6 months
Baseline & controls	Pilot & optimize	Scale what works
Set KPI dashboard; discount approval; paymenting Course Access and Professional pilot completed initiatives baseline		
Launch monitoring and review concentration and ROI monthly		

ROI assumption: each scenario uses an illustrative 1.5× benefit-to-investment ratio for planning. It is not derived from historical incremental profit and should be replaced with pilot-based evidence.

12. Decision checklist & portfolio proof

What to approve, what to measure, and what is included in the submission

Decision checklist

- Approve a controlled Course Access growth pilot.
- Approve a Professional-segment pilot with explicit success metrics.
- Implement payment/discount/concentration monitoring before scaling.
- Require pilot evidence before converting scenario ROI into a budget commitment.

Portfolio contents

- Executive_Decision_Report_FINAL.pdf — this 13-slide executive deck.
- Executive_Analysis.ipynb — final analytical notebook.
- clean_dataset.csv — cleaned transaction dataset.
- Dashboard app source — dashboard/app.py.
- Supporting CSV outputs for summary, revenue drivers, risk, recommendations and ROI.

Final message

Use the dataset as a decision baseline, validate the two growth pilots with additional periods, and institutionalize the risk KPIs before scaling investment.

Source: supplied Retail_Capstone_Project dataset and analytical outputs. All ROI values are explicitly scenario-based.